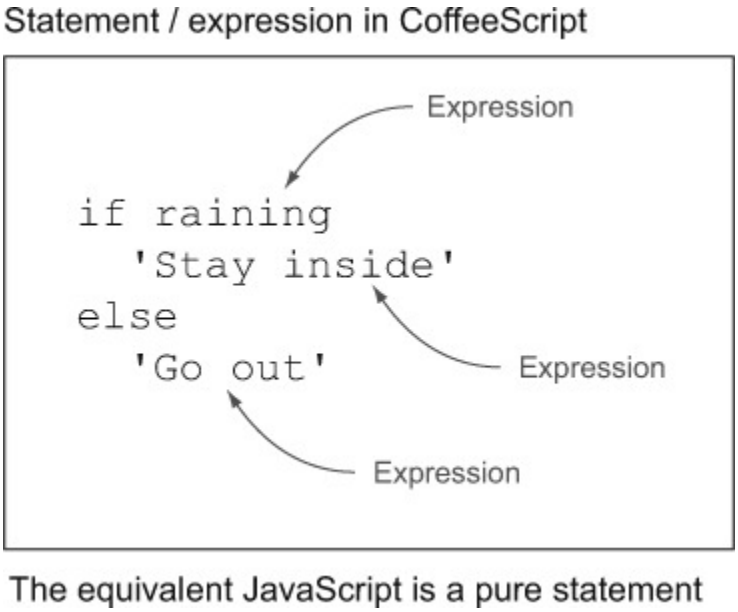


In JavaScript an `if-else` block like this can't be used as an expression. In CoffeeScript it can be.

2.4.2. Statements as expressions

Things that are only statements in other languages, including JavaScript, can be used in CoffeeScript as expressions for the values they produce. Ruby programmers and Lisp programmers will be familiar with the idea that *everything is an expression*, but if you come from a language that doesn't do this, then it's time for some reeducation.

If statements

These are provided by `if` and optional `else` keywords. Use them when you want different things to be evaluated, depending on whether a particular value is `true` or `false`:

```
if raining
  'Stay inside'
else
  'Go out'
```

You can imagine the equivalent JavaScript. It has parentheses and curly braces. More importantly, though, an `if` block is also an expression in